



Lets Play Music

Lesson Plans

These lesson plans are intended to demonstrate how to put together a structured 30 minute lesson using the songs and activities from the Let's Play Music website. Each week we will take a different theme and aim to develop a broad base of musical skills in singing, listening, percussion, pitch, rhythm and understanding.

Ideally the songs should be sung together during the class with some form of accompaniment, piano or guitar would be great but kids are still perfectly happy just singing along together with the percussion instruments instead.

If you work through the material for each lesson plan as listed, it should last around 30 mins, but it is always important to be flexible. Sometimes one activity might be particularly successful and you'll want to do it for longer, or sometimes things don't go quite as planned, so it's always important to have a few old favourites 'up your sleeve'. **Circle games** and **Circle time songs** are always popular, and you can just slot them in if you have a few spare minutes to fill. Choose a quieter activity if they need to settle or something lively if they need to work off the wiggles!

The **Hello Song** which is at the beginning of every lesson can also be used as a Goodbye Song, this works particularly well in a music class where the children just come together for a weekly session. It's a great way to get started and bring the class to a close and helps little ones to understand the routine. If the music lesson is just a part of the normal school day, you may prefer to leave it out.

In the interest of clarity and ease of use, I have tried to avoid making these plans too wordy, and so only give in-depth directions for the more unusual or original activities. However, all the material can be found for reference on the Let's Play Music website. Search for the titles in bold using the search box on the right hand side of the homepage, to check for more details.

Feelings

Focus - A lesson that encourages children to recognise and talk about different feelings and emotions through a variety of musical fun activities.

- Learning solfege with chime bars or resonator bells
- Playing a variety of percussion instruments, recognising the steady beat and the rhythm.
- Listening and concentration skills
- Singing together with actions, new vocabulary, speech development and solo responses.
- Social skills; working in a group, following instructions and building confidence.
- Imaginative movement to music, learning to connect music with emotion and feelings and developing creativity .

Props needed:

- Resonator bells or a xylophone
- A variety of percussion instruments
- The printable sheet music and resources below.
- A cardboard staircase prop, to use with the little coloured emotion characters.
- A selection of coloured scarves or ribbons and streamers to use in musical movement.
- For the Sound game: Some small opaque containers (I use old film canisters, but plastic eggs/kinder eggs would work well too)
- A collection of items that make a distinctive sound eg.: pennies, shells, sugar, rice, bells etc. and a larger box to hide them sound pots in

This lesson is suitable for children from 3 - 7 years and should take around 35 mins, but many of the activities can be used again separately whenever you need a short engaging, musical activity at any other time. These activities are great for exploring and recognising emotions when children find it difficult to express their feelings.





1. **Say Hello** (see blog)

2. **The Do - Re - Mi Staircase with Emotion characters -**

This game works well with the emotion stick puppets included below. It teaches children the degrees of the solfege scale (Do, Re Mi, Fa, So, La, Ti, Do) their correct order, the solfege colours and how they sound.

Using a staircase to illustrate each step or note is an engaging and visual way of teaching the spacial relationship between notes and intervals in a way that children find easy to understand. It's excellent preparation for learning to play an instrument later on. In fact I've have found this game to be so popular and useful as a teaching tool that it is really worth including as a regular part of preschool music lessons.

See Introducing Chime Bars for more information about teaching chime bars)

You can make your own stairs by using our sheet below as a template and mounting it on to strong card. My own Do Re Mi steps are cut out of wood, which you could do if you are handy with a saw, or know someone who is. On the reverse side of the staircase you need to make little pockets out of duck tape behind each step so that you can slot the characters into their correct position. Alternatively there is a Bell Step Ladder available on Amazon (<http://amzn.to/23ksFjU>) which would be more durable. You could attach our little emotion characters to wooden bricks which would work very well and probably stand up to more use.

This game is a perfect way to introduce the emotion theme, helping the kids to recognise and identify different feelings. Once the children know which coloured emotion character goes with which chime bar there are loads of different games you can play:-

First make sure the children are familiar with the Do Re Mi scale. Depending on the age of the children, take time to introduce each character making sure the children are able to recognise and name each colour and feeling and match it to the correct note. This can be spread over several lessons. Keep the chime bars hidden in a box or bag and ask the children to help put the chime bars in the correct order.

Whilst you do this, place the little emotion characters onto their corresponding stair on the staircase as the kids identify each degree of the scale. (attach them to lolly sticks to make them easier to slot in.)

Let the children take turns to guess which chime bar comes next, and give them clues to prompt them

(i.e “It’s the same colour as a banana!”)

This is perfect if you have a group of children with mixed abilities, as you only prompt when needed, depending on their age and ability.

Start with low Do and work your way up the steps until every note is in place.

Another very popular game is to hide the chime bars or little emotion characters around the room and let the children hunt for them, identifying them and putting them in the correct order of the scale as they go.

3. If You’re happy And You Know It

Using the sheet music below, play and sing together with piano (if possible) and percussion instruments.

1st time identify and accentuate the steady beat.

2nd time, identify and accentuate the rhythm (the same as the words)

3rd time, choose just the wooden instruments to play.

4th time, choose just the bells and triangles.

Last time, play and sing loudly all together.

Put the instruments away, and sing the song with the actions.

Each verse add a new action (stamping feet and nodding heads etc.), and at the end see if everyone can remember to list them all one after the other.

4. If time allows you could read a short book about feelings to help introduce the topic, you may have a favourite , but here’s a suggestion:

Sometimes I feel - <http://amzn.to/1SNWAsH>

5. **Magic Feet Follow The Beat!** By now the children will be ready for some movement. Use the sheet below to play this game, it’s a brilliant way to have some fun with some lively movement, while learning and practising the concept of note values.

Use a tambourine to tap the beat, and once they have ‘rubbed the magic on their feet’, they are really in the mood to stamp around with giant steps like Daddy whole note (semibreves) or march like Big Brother 1/4 note (crotchets)



or run along with little fast steps like The Little 1/8 Note Twins (quavers). When they've got the hang of each different note and the sound and action it makes, you can experiment with making them guess which one you are playing and try to catch them out, or each child can have a go at tapping the correct beat when you call out the note.

6. How Are You Feeling Today? Guessing song with emotion stick characters.

*How are you feeling today?
Oh how are you feeling today?
I'm happy and glad, happy and glad,
That's how I'm feeling today.*

*

*How are you feeling today?
Oh how are you feeling today?
I'm grumpy and cross, grumpy and cross,
That's how I'm feeling today.*

*

(repeat the verse with 'sleepy and tired', 'frightened and scared' or any other feelings that you might want to add like 'I'm feeling shy, scared, calm, tired etc)

(sheet music below - same tune as Hickory Dickory Dock.)

This song is a great one for circle time, as it really engages the children and they love trying to guess the different emotions. Give each child a character to hold, and as you go round the circle, the teacher sings the first two lines, asking "How are you feeling today?" and each child identifies which emotion their stick puppet has and sings accordingly. They can use the same words as above, but it really doesn't matter; the whole point is that they should say what they think and feel, and describe the mood of the character that they are holding, so encouraging improvisation and self-expression.

Keep it simple with just a couple of the more obvious emotions to start with and gradually introduce the more challenging ones once they get the hang of it.

You can also prompt them with clues like 'This is how you feel if you see a monster!' Encourage them to join in with giving the clues – there is plenty of scope for some imaginative improvisation!

You can develop this game further by making it into a treasure hunt. Hide the characters around the room and ask the children to go searching for each one in turn. As you sing each verse (you



might have to repeat it a few times while their hunting!) they will see all of the other characters on their way, and they must try to remember where each one is.

Free Imaginative Musical Movement

Using brightly coloured, scarves, ribbons or streamers. Explain that there will be 4 different short music tracks and see if they can guess which mood each one represents. Once you have played and identified the tracks, encourage the kids to move freely with the scarves or ribbons to help them express the different moods.

Happy - Handel's Arrival of The Queen Of Sheba

<https://youtu.be/-TGKJ9MgCOQ>

Sad - Pergolesi's Stabat Mater

<https://youtu.be/IW3GAjAKges>

Scary & Frightened - Carmina Burana - O Fortuna

<https://youtu.be/GXFSK0ogeg4>

Tired & Sleepy - Celtic harp lullabies

https://youtu.be/gaw_KJHkGCA

7. The Sound Game - Listening and guessing game

Here's a box! Here's a lid!

Can you guess, inside what's hid?

Can you guess? Can you hear?

If you listen with your ear!

(Sung to the tune of Little Brown Jug)

You sing the little song, which is very easy, sung to the tune of Little Brown Jug.

At the end of the song you produce one of the sound pots and offer it to the child to shake and listen to. Even very young toddlers love playing this listening game, and if they need a little help you can prompt them with easy clues like 'something you find on the beach' for shells or something that begins with a "sh" sound. They are usually desperate to see the contents, and you will have to be quick to supervise this in order to avoid showers of rice or the threat of small objects.

Ask the children to help you count how many pennies or shells there are inside and encourage them to do this on their own if they want to. Repeat The Sound Box song before you bring out each new sound, and line up all the pots.

At the end, let the child shake each one in turn and see if they remember it's contents without peaking.



Children love routine and order, and the regular sequence of singing, shaking, guessing, counting and then remembering at the end appeals to them. They love the reasoning and predicting element and are reassured by the repetitive pattern of the game. Older children really enjoy playing it too as it becomes a memory game. They will anticipate the sounds, listen carefully, and always love to demonstrate how clever they are

8. Say Goodbye (see **Hello Song** on blog for details)

SUMMARY

Say Hello

Do-Re-Mi Staircase and Feelings stick puppets (see sheet below for sung clues)

If You're happy And You Know It - with percussion & singing (sheet music below) Sing with the actions afterwards.

Magic Feet Follow The Beat (sheets included)

Sometimes I feel - Read the book.

How Are You Feeling Today? Guessing song with stick puppets

Movement to music - with coloured ribbons or scarves to Happy, sad, calm, angry music.

The Sound Game - Listening guessing game.

Say Goodbye





HAPPY



SAD



SCARED



SURPRISED



TIRED



ANGRY

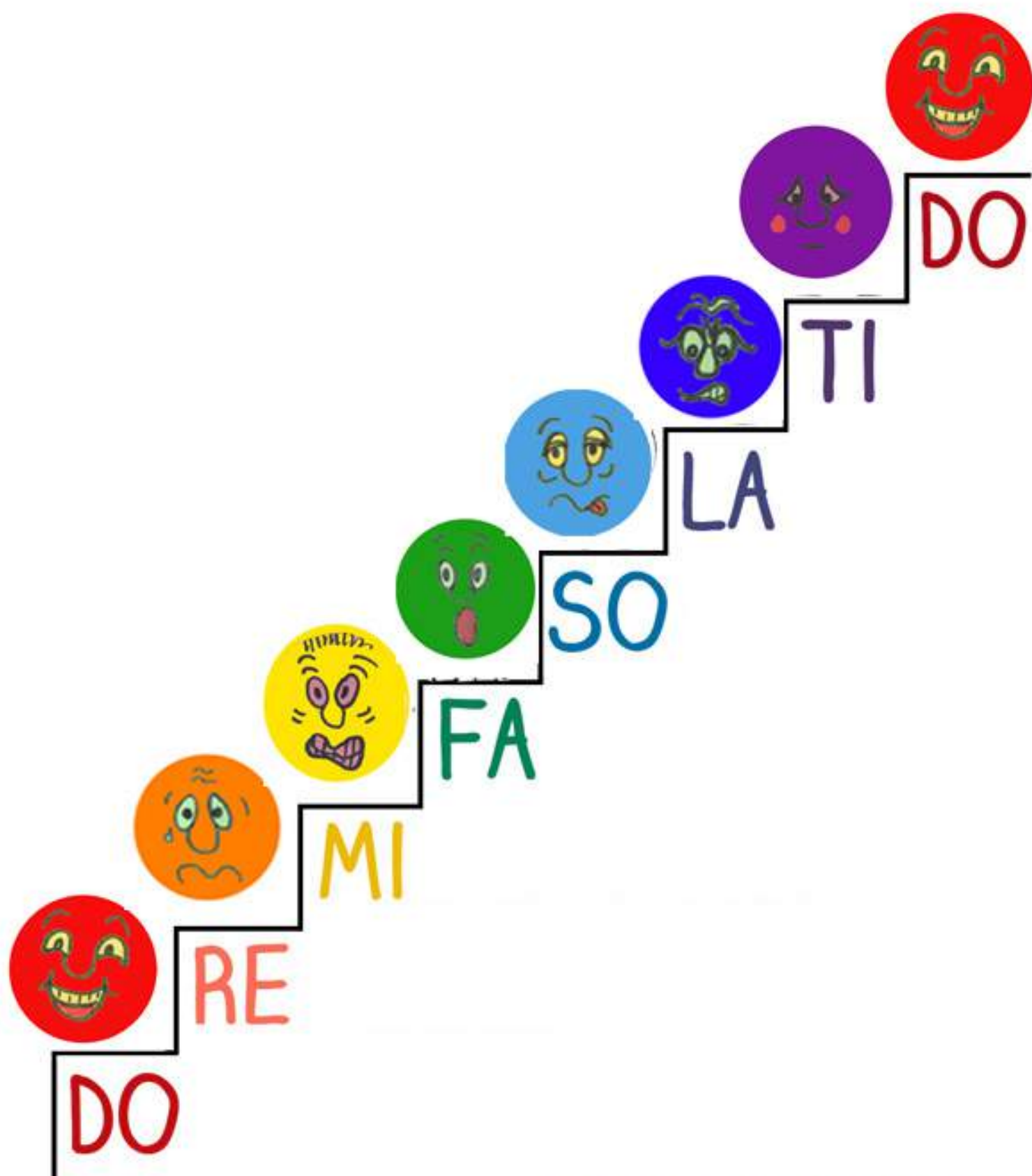


SHY



RELAXED

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If You're Happy And You Know It!

IF YOU'RE HA - PPY AND YOU KNOW IT, CLAP YOUR HANDS, (CLAP, CLAP) IF YOU'RE

The first system of the song is written in 4/4 time with a key signature of one sharp (F#). It consists of two measures. The first measure contains the lyrics 'IF YOU'RE' and 'HA - PPY'. The second measure contains 'AND YOU KNOW IT, CLAP YOUR HANDS, (CLAP, CLAP) IF YOU'RE'. The melody is in the treble clef, and the bass line is in the bass clef.

HA - PPY AND YOU KNOW IT, CLAP YOUR HANDS, (CLAP, CLAP) IF YOU'RE

The second system continues the melody and bass line. It consists of two measures. The first measure contains the lyrics 'HA - PPY AND YOU KNOW IT, CLAP YOUR'. The second measure contains 'HANDS, (CLAP, CLAP) IF YOU'RE'. The melody is in the treble clef, and the bass line is in the bass clef.

HA - PPY AND YOU KNOW IT, AND YOU REA - LLY WANT TO SHOW IT, IF YOU'RE,

The third system continues the melody and bass line. It consists of two measures. The first measure contains the lyrics 'HA - PPY AND YOU KNOW IT, AND YOU'. The second measure contains 'REA - LLY WANT TO SHOW IT, IF YOU'RE,'. The melody is in the treble clef, and the bass line is in the bass clef.

Repeat for each verse

HA - PPY AND YOU KNOW IT CLAP YOUR HANDS. CLAP YOUR HANDS.

The fourth system is a repeat for each verse. It consists of two measures. The first measure contains the lyrics 'HA - PPY AND YOU KNOW IT CLAP YOUR HANDS.'. The second measure contains 'CLAP YOUR HANDS.'. The melody is in the treble clef, and the bass line is in the bass clef.



How Are You Feeling Today?

TRAD.

HOW ARE YOU FEE-LING TO- DAY? OH, HOW ARE YOU FEE-LING TO- DAY? I'M

FEE - LING FINE, I'M FEE - LING FINE, THAT'S HOW I'M FEE - LING TO- DAY!

* SUBSTITUTE DIFFERENT FEELINGS EACH TIME YOU REPEAT THE SONG

LET'S PLAY MUSIC

★ ★ Magic Feet ★ ★ ★ ★ Follow The Beat! ★ ★

A FUN WAY TO TEACH MUSIC NOTE VALUES!

DADDY SEMIBREVE



ta-a-a-a

4 BEATS

GREAT BIG
GIANT FEET

MUMMY MINIM



ta-a



ta-a

2 BEATS

WALKS QUITE
SLOWLY

BIG
BROTHER
CROTCHET



ta



ta



ta



ta

1 BEAT

MARCHES LIKE
A SOLDIER

LITTLE
QUAVER
TWINS



ti - ti



ti - ti



ti - ti



ti - ti

SHARE A BEAT

LITTLE TINY
STEPS
RUN ALONG
BEHIND

★ ★ Magic Feet ★ ★ ★ ★ Follow The Beat! ★ ★

A FUN WAY TO TEACH MUSIC NOTE VALUES!

BIG DADDY
WHOLE
NOTE



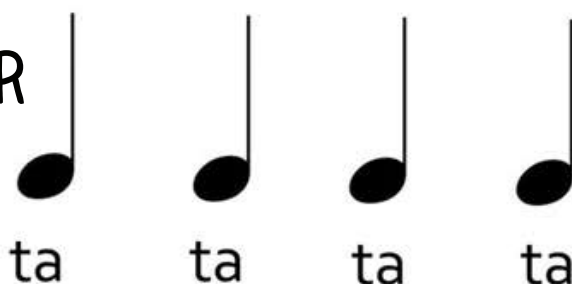
4 BEATS
GREAT BIG
GIANT FEET

MOMMY
HALF NOTE



2 BEATS
WALKS QUITE
SLOWLY

BIG BROTHER
QUARTER
NOTE



1 BEAT
MARCHES LIKE
A SOLDIER

LITTLE
TWINS
EIGHTH
NOTE



SHARE A BEAT
LITTLE TINY
STEPS
RUN ALONG
BEHIND